

The Oil That Did Not Run Dry

By: Anonymous

There was a village set between hills and dust, where the days were long and the nights were quiet. In that village lived a widow and her son. They owned little—only a small jar of oil and a home worn thin by time.

Each morning, the widow measured the oil with care.

Each evening, she prayed it would be enough.

For hunger had learned the road to her door.

One afternoon, as the sun leaned low, a stranger came walking the path. His sandals were torn, and his face bore the marks of many miles. He stopped at her gate and said, "Peace be upon this house."

She answered, "Peace," though worry lived in her voice.

"I ask for a little bread," the stranger said, "for the journey has been long."

The widow lowered her eyes. "As the Lord lives," she said, "I have nothing baked—only a handful of flour and a little oil. I was gathering sticks to prepare one last meal for my son and myself... and then we shall wait."

The stranger looked at her with kindness and said, "Do not be afraid. Make the bread as you have said. But first prepare a small portion for me. Then return and make some for yourself and your son. For the Lord says: *The oil of flour shall not be spent, and the oil shall not fail, until He sends rain upon the land.*"

The widow stood silent.

Fear spoke loudly.

Faith spoke softly.

Yet she chose to listen to the quieter voice.

She baked the bread.

And when she reached again into the jar—there was flour.

When she poured the oil—it flowed still.

Day after day, the hunger waited, but never entered. The jar did not empty. The oil did not run dry. And the widow learned that obedience often arrives before understanding.

When rain finally returned to the land, the stranger departed as quietly as he had come.

The widow stood in her doorway, holding the jar.

It was light in her hands.

But heavy with truth.

And she knew this:

That God's provision is not always loud,

not always abundant in appearance,

but always enough.

Faith is not trusting God *after* we see the miracle.

Faith is trusting Him while the jar still looks almost empty.